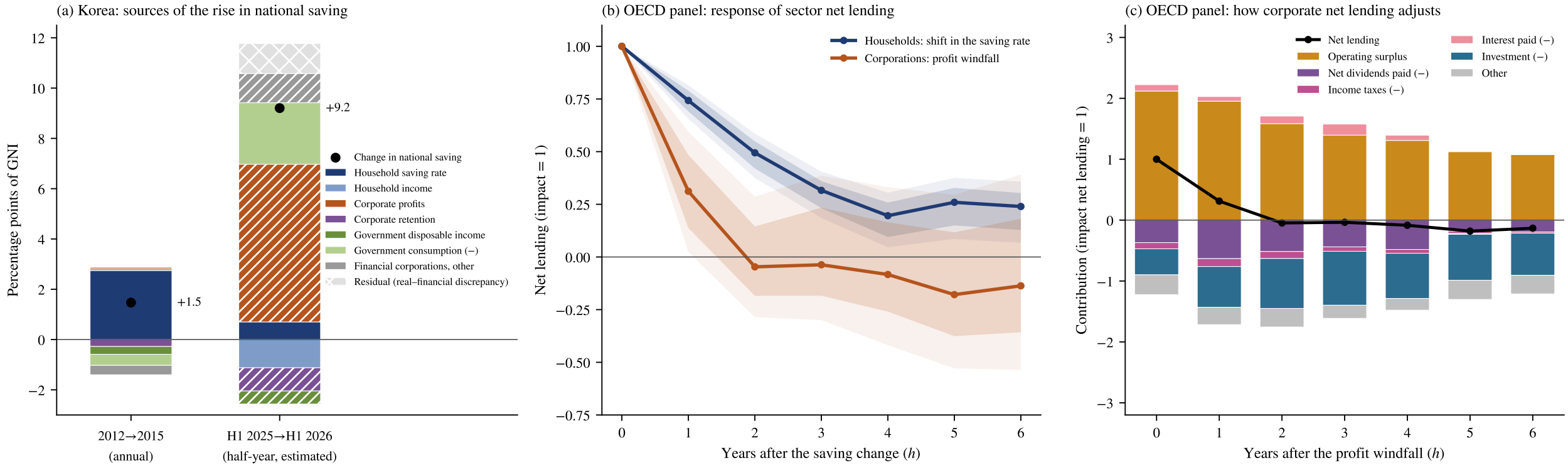
Korea's saving surge then and now, and what the panel says about persistence



Notes: (a) Gross saving, percent of GNI. Corporate saving splits into a profit component (change in operating surplus at the earlier retention ratio) and a retention component; household saving into a saving-rate and an income component; government saving into disposable income and minus final consumption. 2012→2015: OECD annual sector accounts, cumulated over the years. H1 2026: Bank of Korea quarterly accounts; national, household and government-consumption figures are published, hatched components are estimated: sector saving = investment + flow-of-funds net lending + the gap between the two accounts held at its H1 2025 share of GNI (households: published saving); the part of the observed widening of that gap not attributed to households is shown as a residual. (b)–(c) Annual data for 38 economies, 1973–2025 (unbalanced). Local projections with lags of own net lending, both saving components, GDP growth and government net lending, and country and year fixed effects; normalized by the impact response. (b) 68 and 90 percent bands, country-cluster bootstrap (999 replications). (c) Cumulative changes in the items of the corporate account; outlays enter with a negative sign; 'Other' is the remainder. Sources: OECD; Bank of Korea; authors' calculations.